Paediatric Haematology/Oncology Unit
Royal Hospital for Children, Glasgow

Appendix 4:

Department of Haematology/Oncology (Schiehallion)
Royal Hospital for Children
1345 Govan Road
Glasgow G51 4TF
Tel: 0141 452 4475 / 4476

Vaccination of Household Members of Newly Diagnosed Patients

Date: _____

GP
ADDRESS
POSTCODE

Dear Doctor

RE: Sibling

Sibling is a close family contact of a patient who is immunocompromised, undergoing chemotherapy.

Sibling does not have a clinical history of chickenpox. We advise that Sibling receives the varicella vaccine**. I would be grateful if you could refer them to their local immunisation team.**

This recommendation is in accordance with the Department of Health Green Book, Immunisation against infectious disease (Chapter 34: Varicella April 2010).

http://www.dh.gov.uk/en/Publichealth/Healthprotection/Immunisation/Greenbook/index.htm

Chapter 34 details the dosage and schedule, administration, contraindications and recommendations for varicella live attenuated vaccine. Children from one year of age or older and adults should receive two doses of varicella vaccine, four to eight weeks apart (and certainly not less than four weeks apart). The two-dose vaccination schedule provides about 98% protection in children and about 75% protection in adolescents and adults.

Varicella can be a severe disease in profoundly immunocompromised people, at risk of disseminated or haemorrhagic varicella. Transmission of vaccine virus from immunocompetent recipient to susceptible close contacts has occasionally been documented, but this risk is very low. The vaccine recipient should only be isolated from the immunocompromised patient if a rash develops.

Please contact the referrer named below should you wish to discuss this matter any further.

PRINT NAME: _____

Contact details Tel. & E-mail _____

NMC/ GMC number: _____

cc Parents of (add Patient Name)
cc (GGC Patients) Susan Hurley

(letter adapted from template by Dr. Lesley Simpson, Consultant in Paediatric Oncology & Dr Sarah De Martin Consultant in Public Health Medicine, Communicable Disease & Environmental Health)